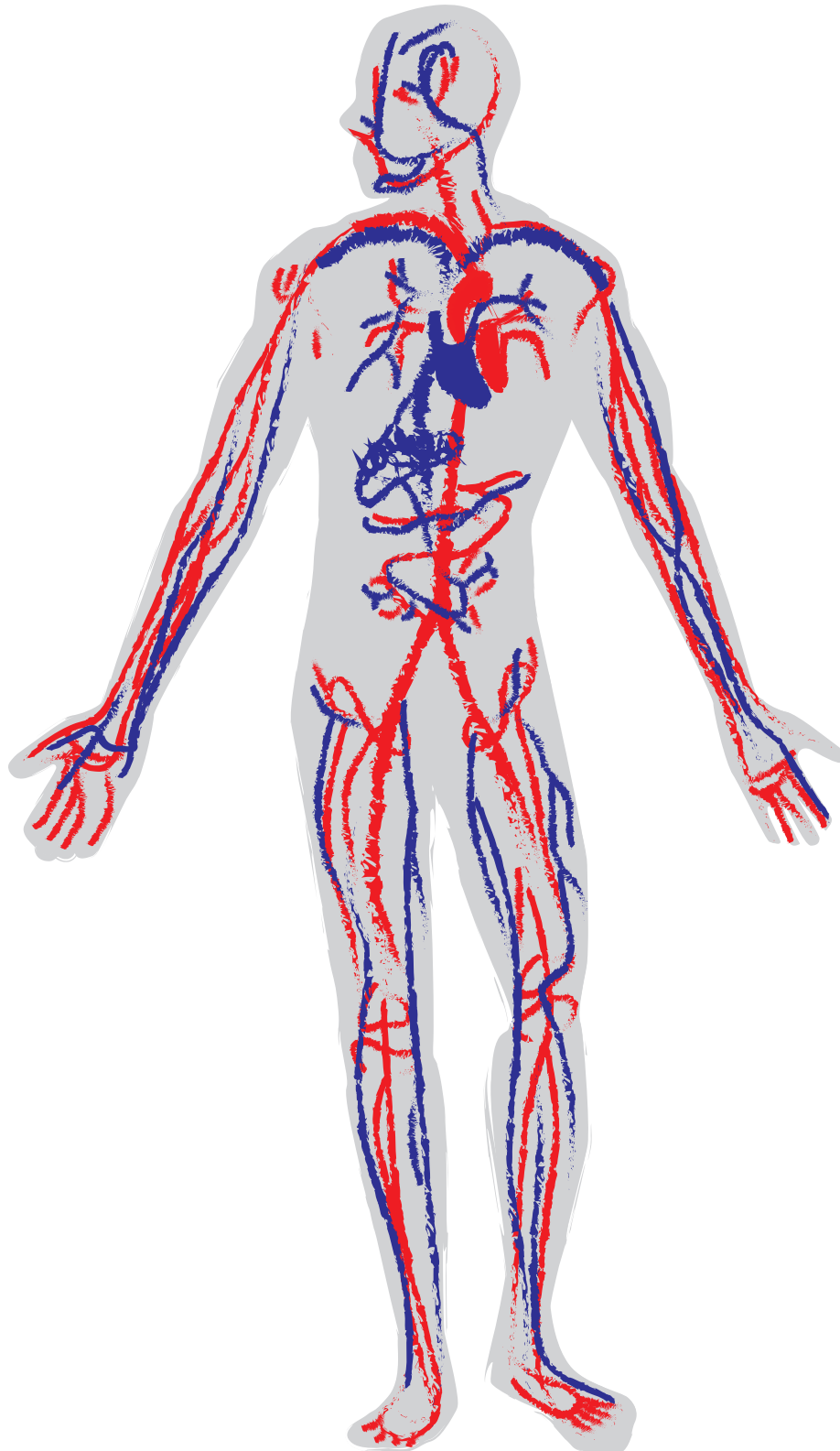
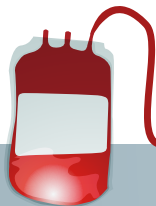


Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 1: Introduction to blood donation

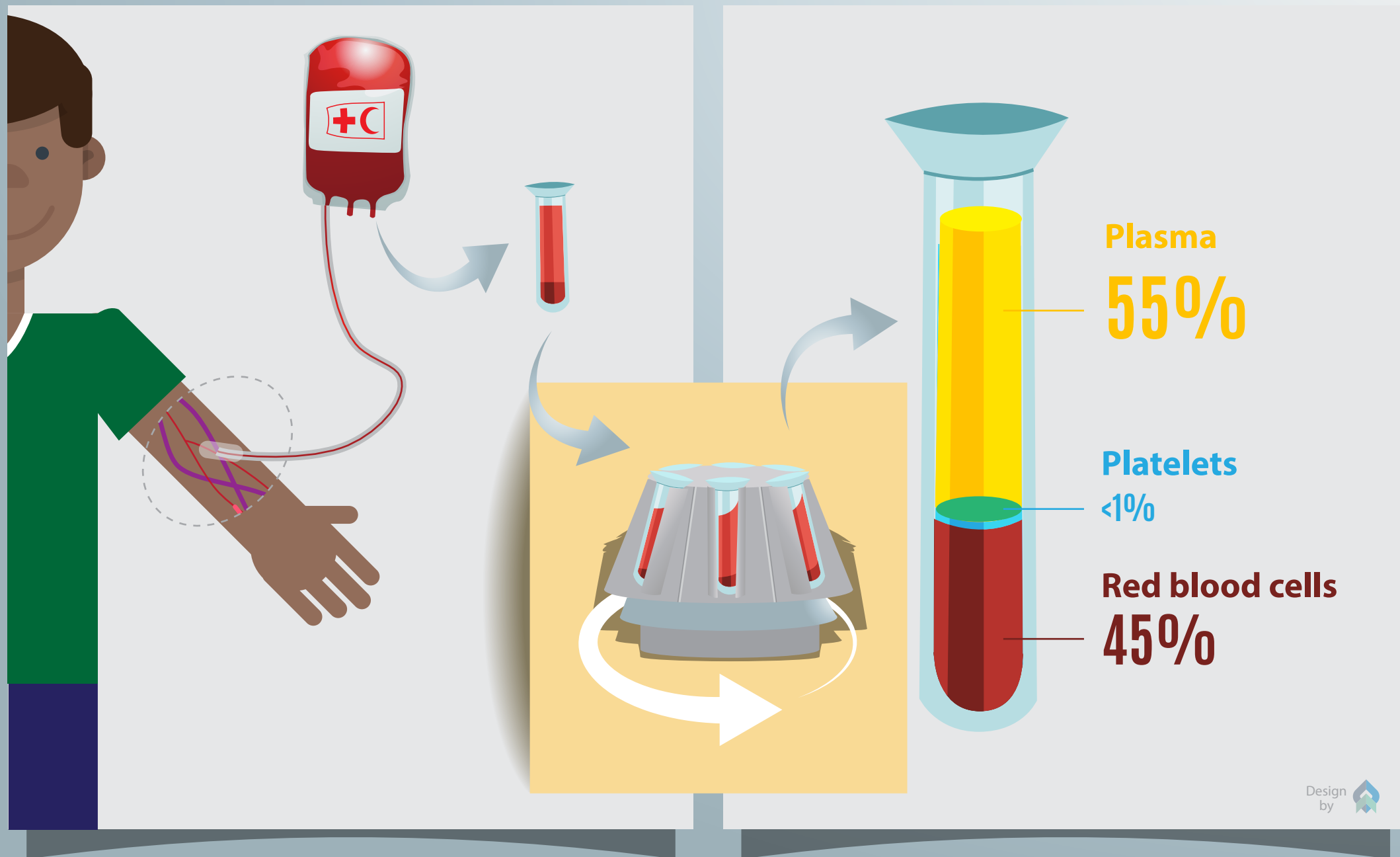
Tool: Circulatory system

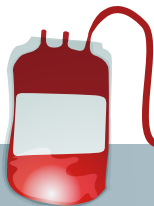




Blood donation and composition

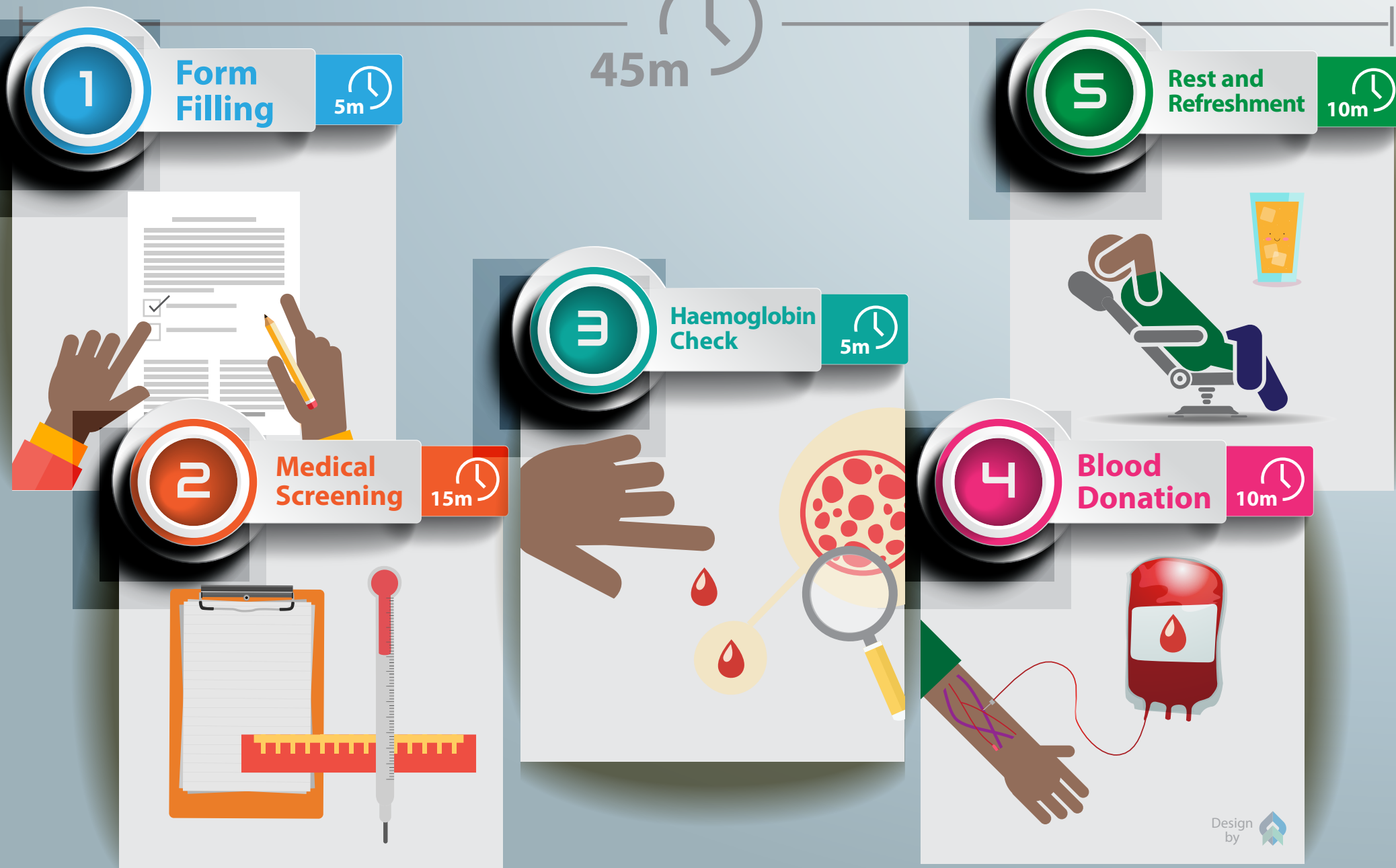
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Blood donation process

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Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.

Rule Sheet

HOW TO PLAY: SET UP

Each player receives a small pawn to move along the game board and puts it on the 'Start' space (on the arm of the blood donor).

Shuffle the Blood Facts cards and place them with the text face down on the board in the designated area. Place all Blood Cell tokens with the numbers facing down on the arm of the blood donor.

The player who most recently donated blood gets to go first. If there are no donors among the players then choose at random.

GAME OBJECTIVE

The first player to reach the 'Finish' space wins the game. If multiple games are played within a larger group, then the group with the highest value of Blood Cell tokens in the 'plasma bag' area wins.



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GAME COMPONENTS

1 A4 game board (for 2-4 players)



4 game pawns (provide your own - coins, pebbles, pieces of paper, etc.)

30 Blood Cells
(tokens with value '1'
(12x), '2' (8x), and '3' (4x))



40 Blood Facts
(cards with 20 truths
and 20 falsehoods)

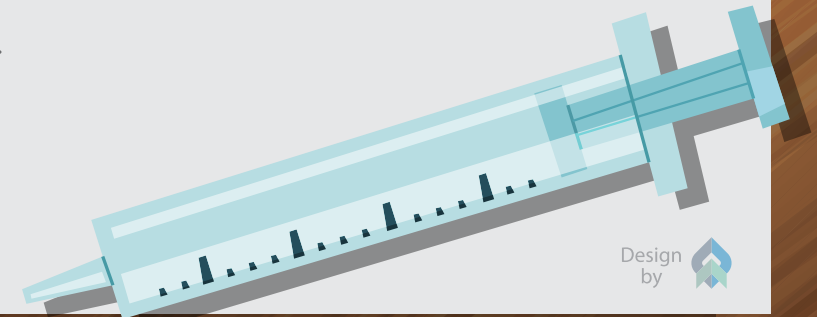
HOW TO PLAY: PLAYER TURN

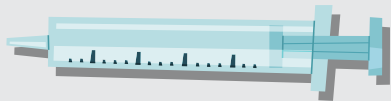
The active player moves one space along the 'plasma tube' from the 'donor arm' to the 'plasma bag' space.

The player to his/her left draws a card and reads the Blood Fact out loud (but not the answer). If there are no more cards, reshuffle the cards on the Discard space, place them with the text down on the Blood Fact card space and draw the top card.

The active player chooses 'True' or 'False.' The player to his/her left reads the answer out loud and places the card on the Discard space. If the active player was correct he/she flips a Blood Cell of choice on the 'donor arm' space and slides their pawn that many spaces ahead and then places the Blood Cell token in the 'plasma bag' space. If the active player was incorrect he/she stays where their pawn is.

If the active player has not yet reached the 'Finish' space, the player to his/her right goes next.





Start

Place game pawns here at start of the game

Blood Cell tokens

Place Blood Cell tokens here (numbers facing down) at start of the game.



Design by



Discard

Place Blood Fact cards here after being played.

True or False

Blood Fact

Blood Fact

True or False

Place Blood Fact cards here (text facing down) at start of the game.

DONATE BLOOD

Finish

Place Blood Cell tokens here after being played.



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Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



2-4



15m



17+



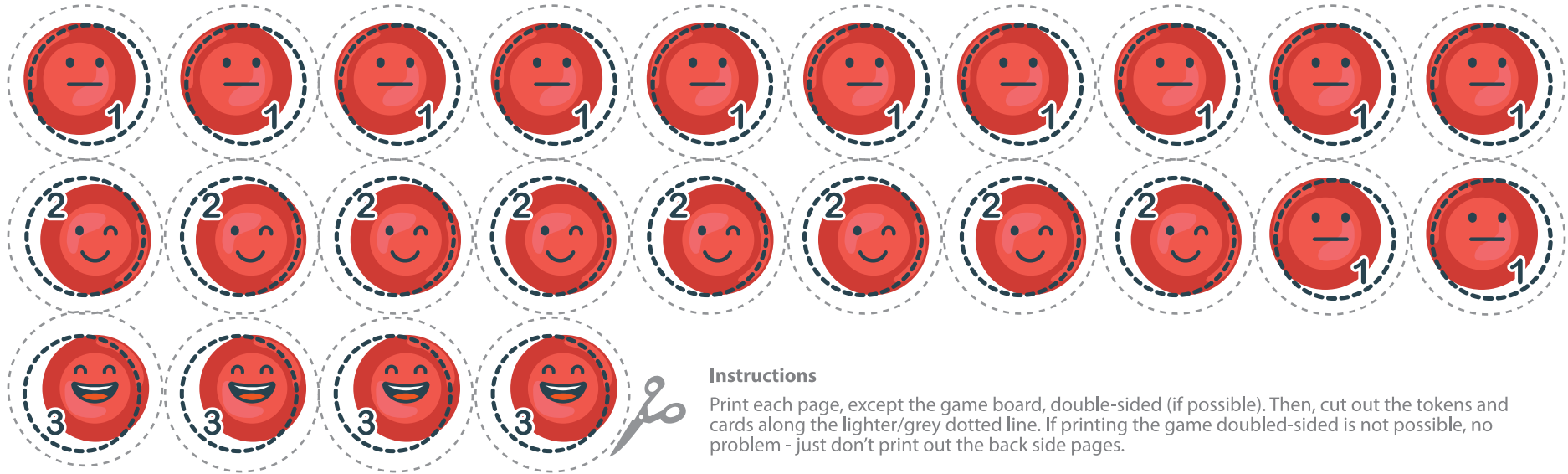
Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Blood Cell tokens



Instructions

Print each page, except the game board, double-sided (if possible). Then, cut out the tokens and cards along the lighter/grey dotted line. If printing the game doubled-sided is not possible, no problem - just don't print out the back side pages.



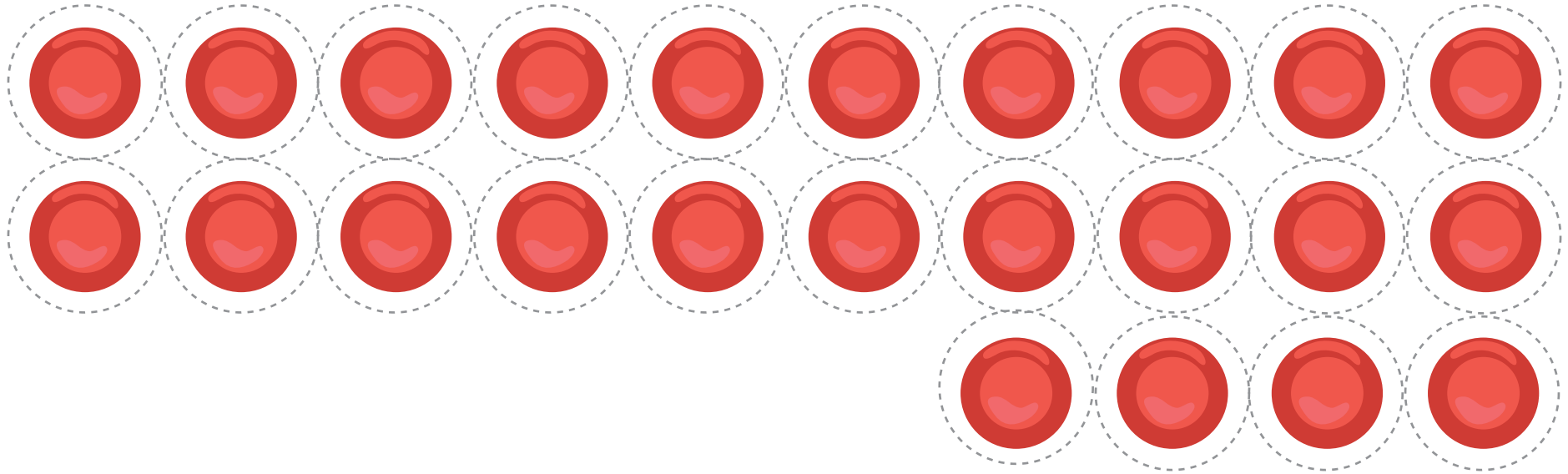
Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Blood Cell tokens





Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Your donated blood can be used to bewitch you.

True or False

False. Your blood is a fluid created by your body to carry nutrients and oxygen to your cells. Once it leaves your body, it has no more interaction with your body or mind and is not able to bewitch or curse you.

Your donated blood will allow someone to get power over you.

True or False

False. Your blood is a fluid created by your body to carry nutrients and oxygen to your cells. Once it leaves your body, it has no more interaction with your body or mind and is unable to exert power over you.

The best way to give blood is to be paid for it.

True or False

False. Voluntary donors who give blood of their own free receive no payment for it (cash, or any substitute for money). Small tokens, refreshments and reimbursements of travel costs encourage blood donation and maintain the safety of blood that VNRBD provides.

They will sell my blood even though I give it for free.

True or False

False. Patients who receive the blood pay a fee. This money is used to pay for sterile equipment, costs for blood bank facilities and the salaries of staff who test, take, process, the blood and separate it into the blood components needed.

Giving blood hurts too much.

True or False

False. Most blood banks will put a cream on your arm that makes sure you don't feel any pain when the needle is inserted. If your blood bank does not, the feeling of a pinprick is less than a second. Once the needle is in, the pain stops.

I will faint if I donate blood.

True or False

False. After you donate, you may feel a little dizzy. But this is why blood banks sit you down, give you a snack and juice and tell you to rest before continuing your day. They don't want you to faint either. Any weakness is usually temporary.

If I donate blood 4 times a year, I can save at least 12 people's lives every year.

True or False

True. You do not need to be a doctor or nurse to save lives. VNRBD donors can save up to three lives each time they donate. Since you should only donate up to 4 times a year, that means your donations can save up to 12 people's lives EVERY year. Wow.

I will gain weight from donating blood.

True or False

False. The weight of a unit of blood that is donated is approximately ½ kilogram. Most people will temporarily lose a little weight from the donation but you return to your normal weight as your body makes more blood.

Giving blood will make a person lazy, weak or fatigued.

True or False

False. Right after you donate, you may feel a little dizzy. Any weakness you feel is usually temporary and you should feel fine in the next hour to resume your day.

I will catch Hepatitis or syphilis from giving blood.

True or False

False. VNRBD centres are extremely careful about blood donor safety, the patients and blood bank staff. A new, clean needle is used for every blood donation making it nearly impossible to get Hepatitis or syphilis from blood donation.

I will run out of blood if I donate blood.

True or False

False. When you donate blood, the blood collection bag sits on a small scale that measures when you have donated one unit and immediately stops taking more blood. It is not possible to give more blood unless you start the whole process over.

I will get bruises if I donate blood.

True or False

False. VNRBD centres are extremely careful about regulating safety for blood donors, patients and blood bank staff. A new, clean needle is used for every blood donation making it nearly impossible to get AIDS from blood donation.

I can get a check-up for free when I donate blood.

True or False

False. Before giving blood, a small test is done to see if you have any disease or risk that makes you ineligible for blood donation. While this test can tell you that you may have a disease, it is not the same as a full check-up.

I can save up to three people's lives if I donate blood.

True or False

True. When blood is separated into its components, each of these components of your donated unit of blood could go to help three people. For 5-10 minutes of donation, that is pretty remarkable.

I can help someone's family member with cancer when I give blood.

True or False

True. If you know someone who needs blood and is of the same blood type, you can donate to that person. But when you donate, you are always helping someone's family member who has cancer, a blood disorder, is having surgery or having a baby.

I can donate blood every three months.

True or False

True. While your body starts making more blood cells as soon as your blood donation ends, it is recommended to limit your donations to every three months to allow your body a full chance to recover.

If someone needs blood and no one has donated, that person will die.

True or False

True. No blood substitute exists. If no one donated blood, millions of people would die unnecessarily every year. There are still not enough donors in the world, so every drop helps someone.

Blood is composed of different parts that help people in need of blood or blood components.

True or False

True. When you give blood, the blood may be given to a patient with minimal processing (whole blood), or as plasma, platelets, or red blood cells.

When I give blood, it is ready for hospitals and clinics to use within 24 hours.

True or False

True. The blood bank immediately assigns your donation a unique ID and processes the blood. It is tested again and if safe, the units are labelled by blood type. The blood is then inventoried and sent out to hospitals and clinics within 24 hours.

I will get a snack right after I donate blood.

True or False

True. After every blood donation, the blood bank will want you to rest and drink water or juice and have a small snack to get your body to start making more blood cells for you to recover what you donated.

If I need blood as a patient, I can use someone else's donated blood to survive.

True or False

True. We never know when we or a loved one might need blood. When enough people donate blood, we can be assured that blood will be available of us when we need it.

I will have the same blood type my whole life.

True or False

True. The blood type you have will never change.

Getting a tattoo makes me a high-risk blood donor but I can give blood after a while.

True or False

True. Needles are used to give a tattoo and the cleanliness of the tattoo needles is not always ensured. To keep blood stocks safe, you cannot give blood for four months after receiving your tattoo.

Having several sexual partners may be a risk for donating blood.

True or False

True. If you have a sexual partner who is involved in any kind of risk behaviour, you should not give blood for at least six months as they might have passed an infection on to you.

Blood Facts cards

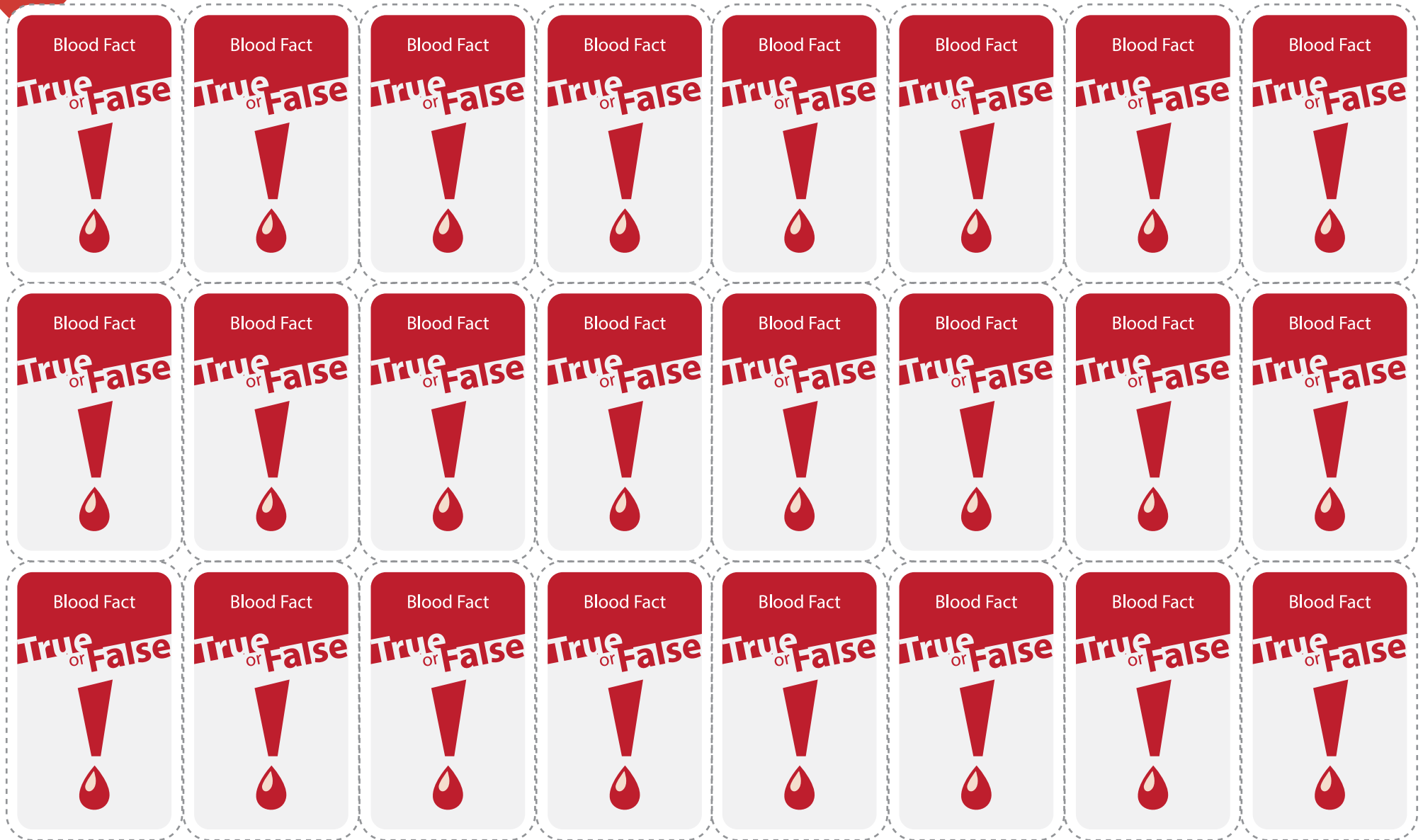


Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Blood Facts cards



Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Blood Facts cards

The four applications of blood are whole blood, red blood cells, plasma, and platelets. True or False True. There are other more specialised types of donation but when you donate blood, the blood is typically used in one or more of these four formats.	The fear of blood donation in some countries means more deaths. True or False True. A lack of voluntary blood donors, and a dependence on family and replacement donors can lead to the need for donated blood not being met.	If I had to suddenly have surgery tomorrow, I may not get enough blood. True or False True. Every country in the world continues to need blood on a regular basis to meet the everyday health emergency needs.	I'm a Catholic and my partner is Protestant. Our religions support blood donation. True or False True. Jehovah Witnesses, a Christian group, forbids blood donation. But this is not stated in the Bible. Most other Christian groups see blood donation as being a good deed in saving others' lives.	I'm a Buddhist and it is believed that blood donation is acceptable. True or False True. There are no Buddhist objections to blood donation or transfusion provided that these are freely given. In some types of Buddhism, blood donation is seen as a way to become a buddha yourself.	Every blood type can donate blood. True or False True. It doesn't matter what blood type you have. Someone who can use your blood will use it once the blood bank processes and identifies the type.	You can only receive the blood type that matches your own or is compatible with your type. True or False True. Recipients with blood type... ...O can receive type O only. ...A can receive types A and O. ...B can receive types B and O. ...AB can receive types A, B, AB and O.	The average person makes 2 million blood cells every second. True or False True. Your body is amazing. Red Blood cells are produced in our bone marrow at a speedy rate to keep us healthy.
Needles are not always clean and might be reused. True or False False. VNRBD centres are extremely careful about regulating safety for blood donors, patients and blood bank staff. A new, clean needle is used for every blood donation.	Giving blood makes my body weak for a long time. True or False False. Right after you donate, you may feel a little dizzy. But this is why blood banks, sit you down, give you a snack and juice and tell you to rest for a little bit before continuing your day. Any weakness you feel is usually temporary.	Anything can happen to me if when I go to give blood. True or False False. VNRBD centres want you to come back because there is a steady need for blood all the time. Blood centres want you to have a safe experience so that you will come back and continue to help others with your donation.	It takes too long to give blood. True or False False. The whole process of giving blood normally takes about 45 minutes, from when you enter until when you have finished your snack and left. But the actual time you are actually giving blood is only 5-10 minutes.	I am a Muslim. My religion says it is bad. True or False Islam does not forbid blood donation. In fact, the Quran says that 'Saving one life is as if saving whole of humanity'.	It is not safe to give blood. True or False False. At least Fourteen tests, 11 of which are for infectious diseases, are performed on each unit of donated blood to ensure safety.	It is scary to give blood. Anything can happen. True or False False. The procedure for donating blood is laid out in detail in Topic 5. There is nothing to fear.	I can catch AIDS from giving blood. True or False False. VNRBD centres are extremely careful about regulating safety for blood donors, patients and blood bank staff. A new, clean needle is used for every blood donation making it nearly impossible to get AIDS from blood donation.



Instructions

Print each page, except the game board, double-sided (if possible). Then, cut out the tokens and cards along the lighter/grey dotted line. If printing the game doubled-sided is not possible, no problem - just don't print out the back side pages.



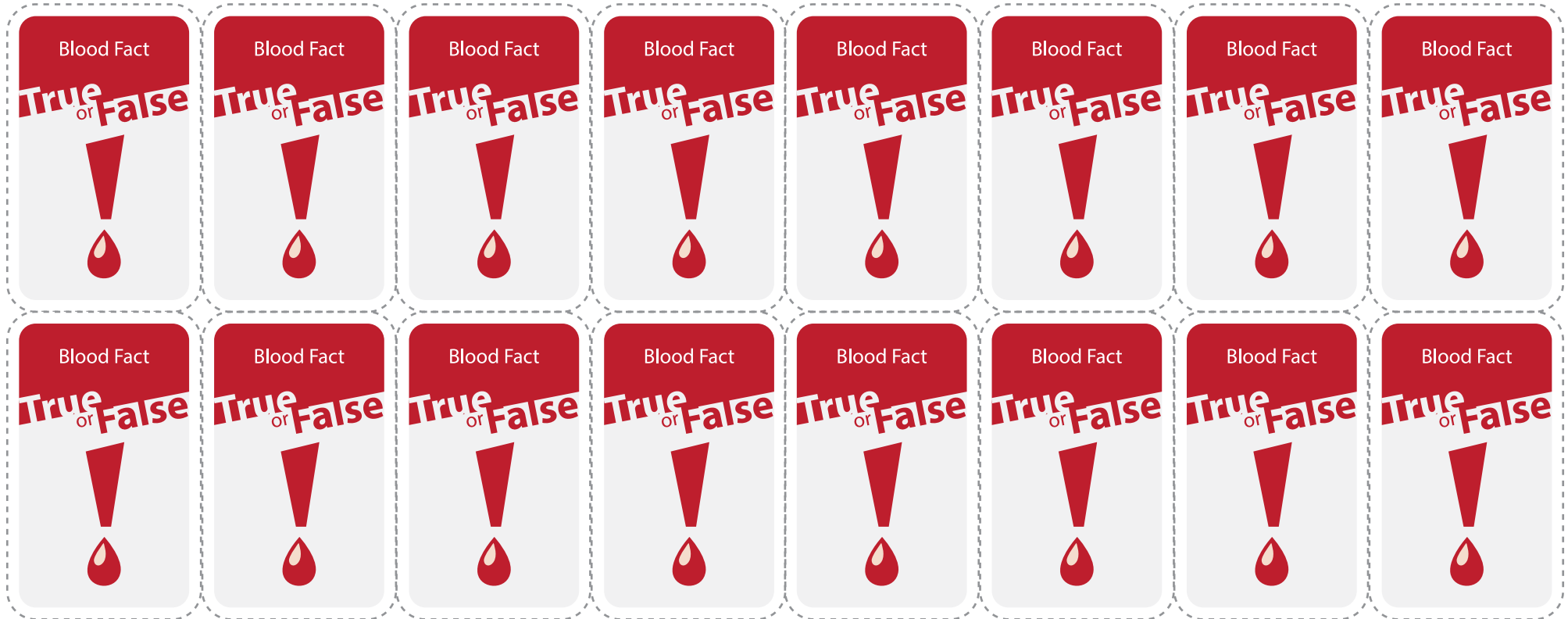
Fact flow

A true or false game about the facts of donating blood.



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Blood Facts cards



eCBHFA Volunteer manual

Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 4: Blood donors are heroes!

Meet Patrick



*whole blood
donor/volunteer
from Sierra Leone
Red Cross*



On June 12, 1993, Patrick Massaquoi celebrated his birthday by giving life to others. His close friend had been boasting for many years that he was responsible for saving hundreds of lives. Patrick was always intrigued when his friend would explain how each time he donated blood, he was directly responsible in saving up to three people's lives. So, on his birthday in 1993, as war raged in his home of Sierra Leone, Patrick went to the hospital to make his first donation. Yes, he was nervous but his anxiety went away when he learned that a pregnant woman who was extremely anaemic was rushed to the same hospital where Patrick was preparing to donate. The woman desperately needed a blood transfusion to save her and her unborn child. The woman's husband was so afraid of donating his blood that he left the hospital, leaving his little family in a dire situation. The nurse who took Patrick's blood told him that his blood type, O+, was just what the mother needed to recover. On the day that Patrick celebrated his birthday, his very first blood donation helped the mother to survive and recover, giving the gift of life to a young life who now celebrates Patrick's birthday with him. Two months after the birth, the woman came to meet Patrick in his village and thanked him for his kind and generous gift. She also introduced him to her baby boy, named Patrick in honour of the man who saved their lives.

The power of how his blood donation saved two lives that day motivated Patrick to continue donating. Patrick has been donating blood every three months since that day, each donation saving up to three lives.

Patrick is a true advocate for donating blood for a healthier community which is made stronger each time he happens to meet someone whose lives were saved by his blood donations, including the mother of one of his close friends who wept tears of gratitude for his selfless act for the good of his community. Patrick's son is eager to reach the age when he is allowed to donate blood so he can help people like his father has done for over 25 years.

Here are the motivations that Patrick refers to about how to become and continue blood donation for the good of your community:

Doesn't it hurt?

For the price of a momentary needle prick, I save up to three people's lives. It is a simple price to pay to help so many. It is so easy.

Blood is not for sale and to save our fellow human beings, we must be ready at any time to donate. Don't allow for an emergency to occur to prepare for saving a life. It is like a bank. You give blood to make a deposit. You can withdraw when need arises.

Does it affect you psychologically?

Yes and it affects me positively every time I donate. In remote areas of Sierra Leone, some people think blood donation will affect them psychologically and that it will offend the spirits. I tell them that blood donation is needed for all and the spirits will be happy. How does it help you? It seems to take a lot of time...

- I am able to track and keep my blood healthy and monitor my behaviours. I know that I need to keep my blood healthy for those who need me and so I keep myself healthy.
- Among my friends, there is a competition on how many units they have donated. Desmond Lewis, Sierra Leone Red Cross' President of the National Association of Voluntary Donors – has donated more units than me so far!
- My family has not yet needed blood transfusion, but I know that I am making regular 'deposits' for when the need arises. Accidents and sickness cannot be foretold. If you volunteer today, it will help you tomorrow. If you help others, people will help you.
- I am always receiving thanks so many times and it makes me feel so good to help.

Can only people in the city donate blood?

I am from Mano town, a remote village and didn't even wear shoes to school. I am not from the city, so I understand that some people have some worries about donating, but these reasons that blood donation is scary or bad are not valid. In some places, there is a mobile blood donation vehicle so that people everywhere can donate.

Why is voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation important?

Voluntary donation is important because it usually means safer blood. Being a volunteer to your community is part of what my father taught me in helping others. My family is focused on helping our family, our community, Sierra Leone as a whole.

Reflection

1. How does Patrick's story of blood donation inspire you?
2. What might motivate a person to donate blood where you live?
3. How many people do you know that have babies? What would you do if you knew they needed blood to survive?

Meet Napporat



สภากาชาดไทย
The Thai Red Cross Society

*Plasma/whole blood donor/
volunteer at Thai Red Cross*

Napporat had always been afraid of needles. She always wanted to donate blood but that fear kept her from going to donate each time her friends were going to the donation center. But then one day – 2 May, 2014, it just happened that she really wanted to donate blood. She realized that for her medical check-up every year, she also felt the stick of a needle for her health and it was okay. The needle for donating blood was the same kind of needle as the one used for blood tests and she felt the same stick. Giving blood for her medical test was never a problem, so she figured - why not save people's lives while she could. This realization helped Napporat manage to surpass her fear of needles and one day when she had some time free from work, she came to the Thai Red Cross blood donation center. She started coming to donate in 2014 which she feels is quite late. 'And I am so sorry now that I started so late – think of all the people I could have been helping all those years I thought I was afraid of needles.'

Napporat has given whole blood 15 times and recently started donating plasma. She learned about plasma donation when she was registering to give blood and when she asked the nurse about the pros and cons of plasma donation, she learned that she could give plasma every 2 weeks instead of only being able to donate whole blood every 3 months. 'So I said, let's go ahead and do that.'

Plasma donation is not available at all blood centers but it takes about the same amount of time but uses a different machine to separate the plasma from the whole blood. And with every plasma donation, Napporat is able to help 3 people.



We asked Nopparat some questions about her plasma donations:

Does donating plasma have any effects on your personal life?

No, not really. I think I feel stronger and more healthy.

What does your family and friends think about your blood donations?

My parents never come for blood donation but when I started to donate blood, I inspired my mother and I even asked her to cook healthier food for me to have healthy blood. She would have liked to donate blood too but unfortunately, she is not able to donate. It makes me happy that I can motivate people with my example. I have one friend who just started giving plasma and another friend has restarted giving blood donations after she had stopped for a while. We are helping so many people!

How much time does it take out of your schedule to come here?

It depends, but usually it just takes 40 minutes. If there is a long line of other people waiting to donate, I might wait up to 3 hours. But it is worth it. My office is close by, so it's not a problem coming here but I need to plan my timing well when it is not too busy at the blood donation center. The Thai Red Cross center is very well organized and the staff here are really working hard, so I feel good about making time to donate.

Do you want to continue giving blood?

Sure, my target is to donate more than 100 times. I started late, but with the plasma it can go quite fast. And I would very much like to just keep going with it.

Why is voluntary non-remunerated important?

In Thailand, we believe that giving blood is a special way to contribute and to save other people's lives. On certain holidays and special occasions, you might have to wait up to three hours to donate blood, because people want to ensure they have paid their proper respects! This part of our culture helps to ensure our collective blood donations allow us to take care of each other, our families, our communities when we most need it.

Reflection

1. How does Nopparat's story inspire you?
2. If you don't donate blood now, how might Nopparat make you rethink about how anyone can donate blood?

Meet Walter



*Platelet donor/volunteer from
American Red Cross*



In 1992, Walter's friend, John, was diagnosed with cancer. Walter knew that his friend was fighting for his life and wanted to know how he could really help him. Walter learned that cancer patients often receive donations of platelets to help them stay strong when the cancer drugs make it difficult for their bodies to fight other infections. Walter did some research and learned that not only was his blood the kind his friend could benefit from but that he was able to donate platelets at the American Red Cross near his home in Pennsylvania. Donating platelets is a special type of donation that takes about two hours to take some of your blood, filter it through the machine seen in the picture and take out some of the platelets from the blood before pumping your blood back into your body. The result is not a big bag of red blood, but a small bag of platelets that the nurse keeps moving about to keep them working strong. Platelet donation can be done more often but it does take longer for the donation. Walter eagerly set up his first appointment and since that day, has been regularly donating his platelets every three weeks. He takes all kinds of measures to ensure he does not cancel or have to miss an appointment because he knows that his platelet donations are saving people's lives every single time. He also loves the family atmosphere at the donation center, 'I love going there – it's the right thing to do for my family, for my community.'

Sometimes Walter learns about the people he has directly helped and is sometimes called in to help a specific case or person needing his platelets. He is especially happy when he learns that his platelets went to a children's hospital to help a sick baby or child. During one donation, Walter was preparing to donate and the Red Cross nurse explained that they would be transferring his lifegiving platelets to a pregnant mother who was suffering in the emergency center of the hospital and needed Walter's platelets to save her life and her unborn baby's life. As soon as the platelets were transfused to the mother, he learned that his donation had saved their lives. Walter thinks about all the lives he has saved over the years and is grateful that he is able to give this gift to so many.

We asked Walter about his motivations and some questions about his donations:

Doesn't it hurt?

It only hurts a little when they prick my finger to test for blood. One tiny little pain and two hours later, I have saved three lives. If I can prevent someone dying, it is worth it every single time.

How is your friend who had cancer?

He is fine and he thanks me for helping him survive. I know so many people who have had cancer. I think that what I am doing can help cancer patients and maybe get cured.

I have to ask. What if you have to get up and use the toilet while you are donating?

The nurses ask me if I need to use the toilet before I sit down to donate, but if you really have to go, the nurses will help you. If you feel unwell during the donation, they can stop it as well. They want to ensure you feel well and take good care of you.

Two hours is a long time to sit. What do you do that whole time?

I bring my tablet and watch movies! The time goes by quickly and the nurses take good care of me. I don't even think of it as a long time. It is now just part of my life.

Why is voluntary non-remunerated blood donation important?

I know that if my family or I ever need blood or platelets that there are donors that will help because I am one of them. It is like paying it forward by taking care of others and you know you and your family can be cared for too. We are all part of a community that helps each other.

Reflection

1. How does Walter's story inspire you to donate?
2. Does your country accept platelet donations?
3. Who might benefit from a platelet donation? How is it different?

Now let's explore how blood donation helps YOU as a recipient of life as blood donor benefits from other blood donors

You are in queue in a shop when you feel dizzy and start to fall. Your world goes black as you fall to the ground. You hear someone screaming and then nothing. You wake up in a hospital bed with lots of beeping machines around you. Your arm has a needle stuck in it and leading up to a bag of blood hanging from a pole. The needle doesn't hurt but your chest hurts a lot and you are scared. Your sister is there and she sees you open your eyes and rushes to your bedside. She says, 'Oh, I am so happy to see your eyes open. You had a heart attack in the shop and they brought you here. The paramedic had to pound on your chest to get it started again but it finally worked. The doctor told me that they had to do emergency surgery on you to keep your heart working. He told me you needed 7 units of blood during the surgery and we are lucky that there was enough blood.'

You take in all this information and despite the pain, you smile a little. As a regular voluntary blood donor for the past two years, you donated blood every three months except for that month when you had the flu and you waited another three months before you donated. You always felt so good everytime after you gave blood because the RC told you that you were helping many people to live. You never knew who they were but you felt good every single time you donated. Now, here you are, benefitting from the kindness of fifty voluntary blood donors! When you look down at the needle pumping that gift of life into your arm, you are grateful for voluntary blood donors. They saved your life.

Reflection

1. Do you know someone who needed blood transfusions to live? Were they donors of blood before they needed the blood?
2. We say that voluntary non-remunerated blood donors are heroes. Explain that statement.

Child Dies for Lack of Blood

Your niece, Maya, was born with sickle cell anaemia, a blood condition where there are not enough normal red blood cells to carry oxygen to the cells and carbon dioxide away from the cells. Maya is only five years old but she gets tired so easily and needs to rest often. She is very small for her age, many people thinking she is only three years old. Sometimes, little Maya says that she feels sharp pain in her belly, chest and even her bones. When these pain attacks happen, Maya lays on the couch and whimpers, sometimes crying out in pain. Sometimes her feet and hands swell and her mother and father can only watch, hold her, and pray the pain passes soon. There are some medications they can give her but they are expensive and sometimes Maya's dad is able to work extra hours to buy them.

During one severe attack, they rush Maya to the hospital. The doctor says that Maya has developed an infection in her blood and needs a blood transfusion immediately. They are relieved because Maya is always better after a transfusion. But the doctor informs them that there is a blood shortage in the country and there is no blood or blood products available at this hospital. The parents want to give their blood but they have the wrong blood types for donating to Maya. They shout, 'But what can we do?' The doctor says she is very sorry and says she can give Maya medication and can ease her pain but she is not hopeful. The nearest hospital is a four hour drive away. Maya is dying.

Reflection

1. 65% of blood transfusions are given to children 5 years and younger in low-income countries. There are MANY children like Maya in the world in need of blood. If the parents were regular blood donors, could this have affected the availability of blood for Maya? Explain your answer.
2. How do voluntary blood donors result in healthier communities for kids like Maya?
3. The hospital had a duty to provide blood for those in need but no blood was available. How can eCBHFA volunteers work with health centres to ensure a steady supply of blood and healthy blood donors?

Man and family saved thanks to RC blood donors

Josef is driving to the hospital for the birth of his first child. He is very excited. Twenty minutes ago, his wife called to say that she was at the market and her water broke. She said that she was being taken to hospital by two of her friends and that he should meet her there. Josef was texting his brother the good news when he tried to make the sharp turn in the road. When he hit 'send' and looked up, his car was speeding into the corn field. He screamed as his car flipped and threw him through the windshield. He felt his head slam into the soft earth just as he blacked out.

He woke up in a hospital bed with bandages covering his body and a machine that breathed for him. He had a sharp pain in his chest like someone was sitting on top of him. He had a needle in his arm with blood dripping into it. He panicked and started to yell, even though the tube in his throat wouldn't let him. A nurse ran into the room and told him to stop yelling. He pointed at the blood dripping into his arm and made a face of disgust.

She adjusted the needle and said, 'Mr. Josef, you are a lucky man today. This blood is what is keeping you alive. You tried to leave most of your blood in that field. You are lucky someone cared enough to donate this blood and save your life.' He watched the blood warily. The nurse continued, 'Your whole family should be thankful for those RC blood donors today because while you were brought here, your wife had to have emergency surgery to get your child out of her body safely. Both mother and son are well but they both needed blood due to complications. The world is smiling on your little family today, Mr. Josef.'

Twelve months later, Josef and his wife carried little Sarath on their journey to the local RC blood centre to register as voluntary non-remunerated blood donors. They wanted to give their own gift back to the community through blood donation. Five years later, after no fewer than 70 units donated by both Josef and his wife, they knew that their gift had cared enough to donate blood to save another family's lives.

Reflection

1. What concerns or fears do you have about blood donation?
2. If you were to receive donated blood, how would you feel towards the donor whose blood is saving your life?
3. How can you repay the debt?
4. How can you help others live through blood donation?



Blood donation process



International Federation
of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies

